

The Blue Sky Ecosystem Projects CIC

Monthly Progress Report & Forward Outlook - September 2026

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1. Strategic Directive from the Managing Director: Phase One Fundamentals

As our vision for The Blue Sky Ecosystem Projects CIC has grown, it has become clear that our long-term goals are both powerful and necessary. However, as Managing Director, I am implementing an intentional, strategic halt on our broader expansion to focus our energy entirely on Phase One fundamentals. Because we are dealing with highly sensitive community topics, we must ensure our internal framework is unbreakable.

Before pushing forward with new initiatives, our immediate priority is securing comprehensive governance, safeguarding protocols, health and safety standards, and appropriate insurance. We are actively engaging with professional advisors, gathering evidence, and completing dedicated social enterprise training to ensure every aspect of our operation is fully compliant. This deliberate step back is not a delay; it is a strict commitment to doing things right, protecting our community, and building an organization that will stand the test of time.

2. Executive Summary

September 2026 has been a period of substantial programmatic development and strategic networking for The Blue Sky Ecosystem Projects CIC. Focus has centered on advancing the core workbook series, establishing foundational community partnerships, and progressing through the School for Social Enterprise (SoSE) course. Crucially, a strategic decision has been made by the

Visionary Lead / MD to deliberately hold our operational pace, ensuring we solidify our governance, safeguarding, and compliance foundations before expanding further.

3. Key Milestones Achieved (September 2026)

- **SOSE Programme:** Active participation in the School for Social Enterprise (SoSE) course is ongoing, with the programme scheduled to formally conclude on Wednesday, 21 October 2026.
- **Strategic Partnerships:** Initiated dialogue with the West Cumbria Freedom Project, with customized follow-up information being prepared for submission next week. Initial, exploratory conversations have also taken place with the founder of The Stronger Dad Project to simply chat and see where potential future alignments might lead.
- **Referral Pathways:** Drafting communications for the Workington Community Mental Health Assessment and Recovery Team (CMHRT) to outline future referral pipelines once the mental health workbooks are ready for deployment.
- **Facilities Planning:** Reached out to the Youth Alliance in Workington to explore securing private meeting rooms for future facilitated workshops; currently awaiting their response.

4. Content & Delivery Status

- **Grief & Loss Series:** Project Associate Mira is in the final stages of completing the first beginner companion book for coping with grief and loss.
- **Domestic Abuse Series:** The primary Domestic Abuse Workbook for perpetrators has been drafted and is undergoing its final polish. Visionary Lead / MD Martin McClure is actively underway with completing the associated companion book.
- **Suicide Awareness Initiative:** We have formally welcomed Jayden Blair on board, who will focus on raising suicide awareness in Cumbria—an area that currently has the second highest suicide rate in the UK. Once formal ICO registration and operational insurance are secured, Jayden will take the lead role in this initiative, driving the development of the suicide awareness workbook and sharing the vision of a unified central support platform.
- **Co-Creation Model:** Solidified the operational standard that all companion books will eventually transition into facilitated workshops, co-created alongside volunteers contributing critical lived experience.

5. Governance, Compliance & Strategic Pacing

- **Statutory Framework:** Advancing formal ICO registration and securing operational insurance. These compliance steps are strictly required before safely onboarding official volunteers like Jayden Blair to provide evidence-based feedback on workbooks.
- **Sustainable Pacing:** In alignment with the Managing Director's strategic directive, a deliberate organizational decision has been made to slow the operational pace. Balancing the concurrent development of Grief & Loss, Domestic Abuse, and Suicide Awareness resources—alongside external outreach—requires careful capacity management. Slowing down ensures all governance requirements are met thoroughly without risking team burnout or creating unnecessary pressure.

6. Forward Outlook & Working Targets (October 2026 Projections)

- **Grief & Loss Finalization:** Complete the beginner workbook and finalize the structural template for the advanced workbook. Concurrently, draft the initial framework for the facilitated course outline.
- **Domestic Abuse Companion Guide:** Substantially advance the beginner companion workbook for perpetrators, bringing it close to completion.
- **Volunteer Integration & Suicide Awareness:** Complete ICO registration and insurance coverage to officially onboard Jayden Blair. The target is to have the suicide awareness workbook drafted by the end of October, with Jayden initiating work on the companion guide.
- **Community Outreach:** Receive feedback from the West Cumbria Freedom Project by the end of October to define if and how The Blue Sky Ecosystem Projects can support their mission.

Please note: As established in our operational ethos, these targets are strictly working projections rather than rigid deadlines. If all milestones are not met within the month, the organization remains committed to the principle that steady, correct progress is always prioritized over rushed delivery.